

# ZHANLI LI

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🏠 zhanli-li.github.io 🌟 Zhanli-Li (190+ stars)

## EDUCATION

**Zhongnan University of Economics and Law**

*September 2023 – June 2027*

Wenlan School of Business (Honors College), B.Sc. in Digital Economy

**Weighted Avg: 93.73/100   Rank: 2/80   2025 National Scholarship**

**Major Courses:** Neural Networks, Machine Learning, Mathematical Modeling, Mathematical Analysis, Probability and Statistics

**Research Interests:** LLMs, Agentic Training, Document Intelligence, Causal Inference

## PUBLICATIONS

**Zhanli Li**, Huiwen Tian, Lvzhou Luo, Yixuan Cao, Ping Luo. *DeepRead: Document Structure-Aware Reasoning to Enhance Agentic Search*. *KDD 2027 (CCF-A)*, **Resubmit**. [**First Author**]

**Zhanli Li**, Yixuan Cao, Lvzhou Luo, Ping Luo. *Navigating Large-Scale Document Collections: MuDABench for Multi-Document Analytical QA*. *ACL 2026 Findings (CCF-A)*. [**First Author**]

**Zhanli Li**, Zichao Yang. *ESG Rating Disagreement and Corporate Total Factor Productivity: Inference and Prediction*. *Finance Research Letters*, vol. 78, p. 107127, 2025. (CAS Q1 Top, JCR Q1, IF: 6.9). [**First Author**]

## PROJECT EXPERIENCE

**Data Agent Training of LongCat 2.0<sup>‡</sup>**   *Research Intern, LongCat Interaction*   *May 2026 – Present*

To address the limitations of foundation models in data analysis, such as **insufficient drill-down** and **surface-level insights**, I design post-training strategies for **Data Agents** around **LongCat 2.0 Pro**. I built a **synthetic interactive analysis environment generation pipeline** that turns business-analysis scenarios into controllable data environments, a **trajectory filtering pipeline** that selects deeper and more reliable analytical traces, and explored **mixing-ratio strategies** with other post-training data to improve **drill-down ability** and **insight quality** on BA Agent / Data Agent tasks.

▷ Built scalable environment synthesis, deep-analysis trajectory filtering, and Data Agent data-mixing workflows for post-training; the workflow supports iterative data production, quality screening, and capability evaluation for LongCat 2.0 Pro.

**DeepRead: Document Structure-Aware Reasoning to Enhance Agentic Search<sup>†</sup>**   *First Author*   *October 2025 – February 2026*

Proposed **DeepRead**, a structure-aware document reasoning agent that preserves layout fidelity via OCR, constructs **paragraph-level coordinates**, and equips LLMs with **Retrieve** and **ReadSection** tools. Unlike flat chunk-based agentic search, DeepRead explicitly models document hierarchy and reading order, allowing the agent to first locate relevant regions and then inspect complete local context. The method induces a “locate-then-read” reasoning paradigm and improves over **Search-o1** style baselines by an average of **10.3%** across four multi-type document benchmarks.

▷ **Resubmit to KDD 2027 (CCF-A)**; the preprint was reported by the prominent technology media **New Wisdom**.

**MuDABench: Multi-Document Analytical QA Benchmark and Multi-Agent Framework<sup>†</sup>**   *First Author*   *April 2025 – December 2025*

Constructed **MuDABench**, a multi-document analytical QA benchmark with **80k+ pages**, **332 questions**, and **4,964 structured intermediate facts**, to evaluate multi-document retrieval, cross-document aggregation, and numerical reasoning over large document collections. The benchmark uses structured intermediate

facts to expose where a system fails: document selection, single-document extraction, cross-document aggregation, or final numerical reasoning. Designed a **Multi-Agent** workflow that substantially improves over standard retrieval baselines.

▷ **Published in** *ACL 2026 (CCF-A)*.

**SHAP-Based Causal Inference Framework for Corporate Finance\***    *Project Leader*    *September 2024 – January 2025*

Built an interpretable machine learning framework combining manually coded panel data and **Optuna** hyperparameter optimization, achieving  $R^2 = 0.76$  on corporate total factor productivity prediction. Further used **SHAP** to quantify the **nonlinear marginal contribution** of ESG rating disagreement to outcome variables and reveal potential causal pathways linking heterogeneous ESG signals with productivity outcomes.

▷ **Published in** *Finance Research Letters* (CAS Q1 Top, JCR Q1, IF: 6.9); received the Outstanding Paper Award at the Tsinghua Causal Inference Seminar.

<sup>†</sup>*Supervised by* **Institute of Computing Technology, Chinese Academy of Sciences** professors Yixuan Cao and Ping Luo; <sup>‡</sup>*supervised by* **LongCat Interaction** Feng Hong; <sup>\*</sup>*supervised by* **Wenlan School of Business** Zichao Yang

## INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

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**Meituan LongCat Interaction (Foundation Model Team)**    *May 2026 – Present*

**Role:** Research Intern    **Mentor:** Feng Hong    **Project:** Improving BA Agent capabilities; participated in post-training and capability enhancement of **LongCat 2.0 Pro** for real-world business data analysis scenarios, with emphasis on data construction, trajectory quality control, and evaluation of deeper analytical behavior.

**Beijing Paoding Technology Co., Ltd. (AI Startup) — Research Dept.**    *June 2025 – February 2026*

**Role:** AI Research Intern    **Mentors:** Ping Luo, Yixuan Cao    **Project:** Improved context retrieval in production-grade RAG systems by optimizing context-missing issues with **PDFflux** and **ChatDOC**; worked on retrieval completeness and document-context preservation for complex financial-document scenarios.

## COMPETITION EXPERIENCE

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**NVIDIA Nemotron Model Reasoning Challenge**    *Silver Medal*    *June 2026*

Based on **Nemotron-3-Nano-30B-A3B** and the competition-required **LoRA** fine-tuning setting, built an agentic reasoning framework for abstract puzzle solving and organized induced rules into reusable solvers. Achieved a score of **0.86**, ranking **119/4182** globally.

## HONORS & SERVICE

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**China National Scholarship**    *November 2025*

Received the highest national-level undergraduate scholarship in China for academic excellence and research potential.

**China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling**    *November 2025*

Won First Prize as team leader; responsible for problem formulation, modeling strategy, algorithm implementation, and final paper organization.

**Academic Service**    *2025 – Present*

Served as an independent reviewer for *Finance Research Letters*; reviewed empirical corporate-finance and machine-learning manuscripts with attention to identification, robustness, and reproducibility.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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**Programming / Tools:** Python, C/C++, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Markdown, Docker, SSH, tmux, Ubuntu    **English:** CET-4: 522, CET-6: 508

**Libraries & Frameworks:** ms-swift, vllm, verl, llamaindex, transformers, torch, sklearn, pandas, numpy